

10-Day Trip Cheat Sheet

The volume math, the laundry strategy, and the bag-size ranges — one page to pack against.

THE CORE LIST

Tops	5–7 without laundry · 4–5 with laundry
Bottoms	2–4
Underwear & socks	7–10 pairs · ~5 with mid-trip laundry
Mid layer	0–1 depending on climate
Shoes	worn — every packed pair costs ~4–5L
Toiletry kit	1, compact

THE LAUNDRY STRATEGY — WHAT MAKES 10 DAYS PACKABLE

- One mid-trip laundry stop cuts clothing volume by roughly a third: 10 days packs like 5–6.
- Realistic options: hotel laundry (priciest), a laundromat hour, or sink-washing quick-dry fabrics.
- No laundry access? That's fine — pack the full counts and expect the larger bag range below.

THE VOLUME MATH

- Ultralight / light packers: 35–40L
- Standard packers (most people): 40–45L — a 40–45L carry-on works for disciplined packers WITH laundry
- No laundry: standard packers typically need 40–50L
- Cold weather, extra shoes, or a laptop push 10-day trips toward 45L+ or a checked bag — that's normal, not failure.

THREE RULES THAT SAVE THE MOST SPACE

- Wear the bulkiest items (shoes, jacket) on travel days.
- Quick-dry fabrics make the laundry strategy work — cotton doesn't dry overnight.
- Compression cubes save a real 15–30% on soft clothing — helpful, not magic.